Use ChatGPT to Get Organized Now That Mom Has Medicaid

Four prompts to sort the letters you've received, list what has changed since approval, put the dates you know on one page, and gather the questions to bring to a professional.

Where you are

Mom's Medicaid was approved. The letters keep coming, nobody has said what the family needs to keep doing, and it would be easy to assume the process is finished.

This guide gives you four ChatGPT prompts to organize what you already know and to see what you don't know yet. It is preparation, not an assessment. Use only information you have permission to share, with names, ID numbers, case numbers, and account numbers removed. The AI organizes and drafts; it does not know your state's Medicaid rules, and it does not decide what has to be reported or whether anything affects eligibility. Bring those questions to the Medicaid agency, your Medicaid planner, or an elder law attorney. The agency's own notices are the authority on dates and requirements.

What you'll have at the end

You can say what the letters ask for, which dates you know and which you don't, what has changed since approval, and the questions the Medicaid agency or a professional still has to answer.

A one-page list: What we know, What we don't know, Questions we need answered, and who to ask.

Before you start

- The approval notice and any later letters from Medicaid, or your notes on them.
- Your notes on anything that has changed since the application: income, accounts, where Mom lives, her care.
- A calendar. You don't need everything.

PROMPT 1

Start with what Medicaid has sent you

WHY THIS MATTERS

The approval notice and the letters after it are the most reliable record of what the agency expects from your family. It's easy to file them unread once the answer is yes.

WHAT YOU'LL NEED

The approval notice and any later letters, or your notes on them, with names and numbers removed.

COPY THIS PROMPT

> My mother was approved for Medicaid. Here is what the letters we've received say, in my own words or copied with names and numbers removed:

> [PASTE YOUR NOTES]
>
> Using only what I've pasted, make a table with one row per letter: the date on it, what kind of letter it says it is, anything it asks us to do or send, and any date it mentions. Add a last column called I DON'T UNDERSTAND for wording that is unclear to me. Do not explain what the letters mean, and do not add Medicaid rules that are not in my notes.

WHAT TO LOOK FOR

A plain list of what has arrived, with the requests and dates in one place and the confusing parts labeled.

WHAT TO DO NEXT

Put the letters themselves in one folder, in date order, with the table on top.

PROMPT 2

List what has changed since approval

WHY THIS MATTERS

Financial or living circumstances can change after approval, and the application described one moment in time. Writing down what is different now is the first step to asking the right person about it.

WHAT YOU'LL NEED

Your notes on income, accounts, property, where your mother lives, her care setting, and any money that has arrived or is expected.

COPY THIS PROMPT

> My mother was approved for Medicaid. Here are my notes on her income, accounts, property, living arrangements, marital status, and care setting, and on anything that has changed or may change:
>
> [PASTE YOUR NOTES]
>
> Sort what I've written into four lists: HAS CHANGED SINCE APPROVAL, MAY CHANGE SOON, NO CHANGE THAT I KNOW OF, and I HAVEN'T CHECKED. Include any money that has arrived or that we expect, such as an inheritance, a gift, a sale, or an insurance payment. Do not tell me whether any change has to be reported or whether it affects her eligibility. Those are questions for the Medicaid agency or a professional.

WHAT TO LOOK FOR

The I HAVEN'T CHECKED list, and anything in the first two lists that nobody has asked about yet.

WHAT TO DO NEXT

Look into the items you haven't checked. If money has arrived unexpectedly, ask about it before acting.

PROMPT 3

Put the dates you know on one page

WHY THIS MATTERS

Renewals, deadlines, and requests come with dates, and the dates come from the agency's letters, not from a general rule. A page that shows which dates you have and which you don't tells you what to ask.

WHAT YOU'LL NEED

The table from the first prompt and any other dates you've been given.

COPY THIS PROMPT

> Here is the table of letters we've received from Medicaid, and any other dates I know about:
>
> [PASTE THE TABLE FROM PROMPT 1 AND YOUR OTHER NOTES]
>
> List every date in my notes in order, with what it is for and which letter it came from. Then list the things I would expect to have a date for but don't, such as the next renewal, under DATE NOT FOUND. Do not estimate or supply any date that is not in my notes, and do not tell me how often Medicaid renews.

WHAT TO LOOK FOR

A short date list you can copy to a calendar, and a DATE NOT FOUND list to ask about.

WHAT TO DO NEXT

Add the known dates to a calendar with reminders, and take the DATE NOT FOUND list into the last prompt.

PROMPT 4

Sort your questions by who can answer them

WHY THIS MATTERS

Some questions the family can answer by looking in a folder. Others belong to the Medicaid agency, a Medicaid planner, or an elder law attorney. Knowing which is which is the point of this guide.

WHAT YOU'LL NEED

Everything from the first three prompts.

COPY THIS PROMPT

> Here is everything I've organized about my mother's Medicaid since approval:
>
> [PASTE EVERYTHING FROM PROMPTS 1 TO 3]
>
> Give me one page with three headings: WHAT WE KNOW, WHAT WE DON'T KNOW, and QUESTIONS WE NEED ANSWERED. Under the last heading, mark each question with who should answer it: family, the Medicaid agency, a Medicaid planner, an elder law attorney, or not sure. Do not answer the questions about rules, reporting, or eligibility yourself.

WHAT TO LOOK FOR

One page you could hand to someone and have them understand where things stand.

WHAT TO DO NEXT

Keep the page. It's the start of the next step below.

Ready for the next step?

You've organized what you know and what you don't. The planning interview asks about your family's situation and produces a free planning report you can bring to your Medicaid planner.

Get Your Free Planning Report ›